

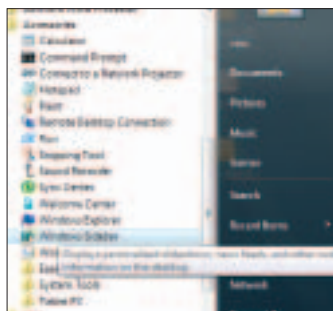
Getting more from Sidebar Gadgets

There's more to Vista's Sidebar than a clock, a photo slideshow and some news headlines

We wouldn't claim that the Sidebar is a 'secret' feature of Windows Vista — after all it's usually the first thing that people notice about the new operating system. What's less well known, however, is that Vista allows you to customise the Sidebar and the Gadgets it contains. Gadgets are mini programs that live in the Sidebar. They can connect to web services to deliver weather information, news updates, traffic maps and slideshows of photo albums. You don't need to stick to the Gadgets provided in Vista by default, either. With many more Gadgets available free of charge, you can choose from an almost limitless selection of useful tools, such as calculators, games, news, weather, media and communication applications. Follow the tips below to find out how you can put your Sidebar to better use.

Tip 1

Windows Sidebar is a pane that runs down one side of the Microsoft Windows Vista Desktop (usually the right-hand side), where you can keep your Gadgets organised and always accessible. If the Sidebar is not displayed, you can open it by going to Start > All programs >



Accessories and clicking on the Windows Sidebar option. Depending on how you work, you can choose to keep the Sidebar sitting behind any applications you have open or set it to be visible at all times. To do this, click the Start button then Control Panel. Choose Appearance and Personalisation, and then click Windows Sidebar Properties. Choose the 'Sidebar is always on top of other windows' check box and click OK.